Athlete Marketing Plan

By Nolan Spenker

Part One

Who is Hailey Van Lith?

Hailey Van Lith (HVL)

Women's Basketball • Guard • 5'9

Past Teams: Louisville, LSU, TCU

Current team: WNBA's Chicago Sky

Who is HVL?:

- Competitive
- Authentic
- Personable

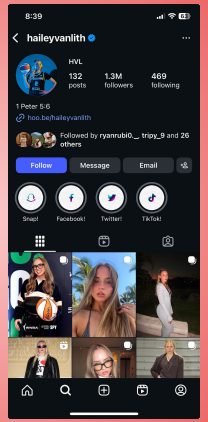
HVL: Social Audit

Total Estimation ~ 2.05 million

Instagram (~1.4 million)

Majority of posts promote her outfits/what she is wearing/lifestyle…

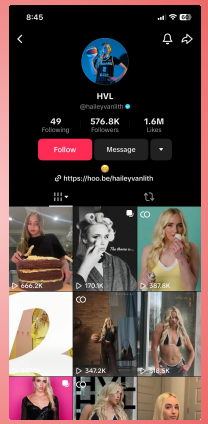
E.X: Gameday fits



TikTok (~576.8k)

Majority of posts promote a brand…

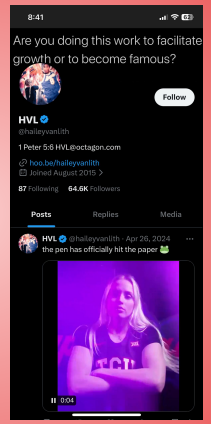
E.X: Behind the Scenes Sports Illustrated colab



Twitter/X (~64.6k)

Majority of posts are announcement related…

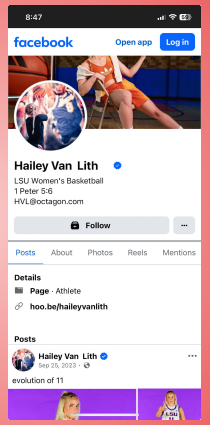
E.X: College transfer decision



Facebook (~25k)

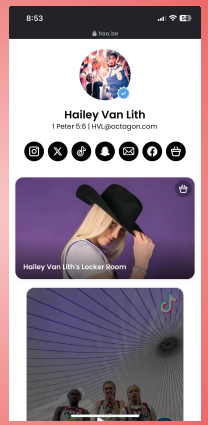
Majority of posts are professional…

E.X: Headshots for the upcoming szn



Website

Social Media pages funnel to the website where she used to sell TCU merchandise (currently no products available)



Fan Pages

Hailey Van Lith has a massive fan following, including numerous Instagram fan pages as well as TikTok edits made for her play on the court and her fashion off the court. This reaches consumers indirectly with her name, image, and likeness.

Content Themes

Athletics

Her athletics content is the focal point of her social media pages due to her proficient skill set on the basketball court. This takes up a majority of her posts, not only promoting herself, but the team she represents and the branding on the team jerseys.

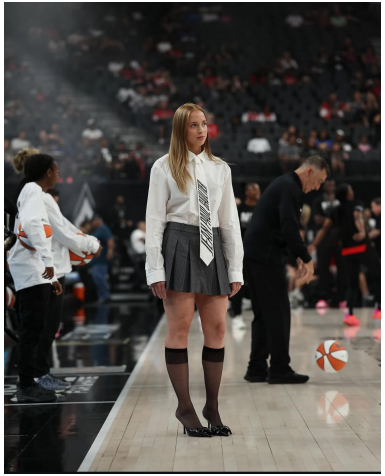
Lifestyle

Van Lith promotes her unique fashion many times throughout her socials. Countless times she has posted her gameday fits or even streetwear apart from basketball. It is clear that fashion is something Van Lith prioritizes and wants the world to know.

Personal

Although Van Lith does not share my personal information regarding family, she does express her love for God. She has 1 Peter 5:6 in every social media biography, and consistently references God and philosophical quotes in her captions.

Consistently gives off confidence and authenticity in everything she does



Year in Review: HVL's Top 5 Posts

Criteria: top engagement within a defined category (athletic, lifestyle, or personal)

Posted March 12th, 2025 • 425k likes

Description: Hailey Van Lith partnered with the Instagram account to post a March Madness hype post. This partnership prompted it to be put in front of the 697 Million Instagram account followers.

"What I love about March Madness is that anything can happen out there…you can't take any game for granted" - HVL on the post

She also used the platform to promote her fashion, gym-routine, shoe collection, bracelet collection, and puzzle-addiction.

Category: Athletics x Lifestyle

Posted March 24th, 2025 • 220k likes

Description: Hailey Van Lith posted pregame and game pictures of their round of 32 matchup versus Louisville in March Madness.

This garnered a lot of attention considering Van Lith led the Horned Frogs to an 85-70 victory.

Van Lith used a famous quote from Greek Philospher Heraclitus as her caption, denoting the demeanor she has for her own personal reputation.

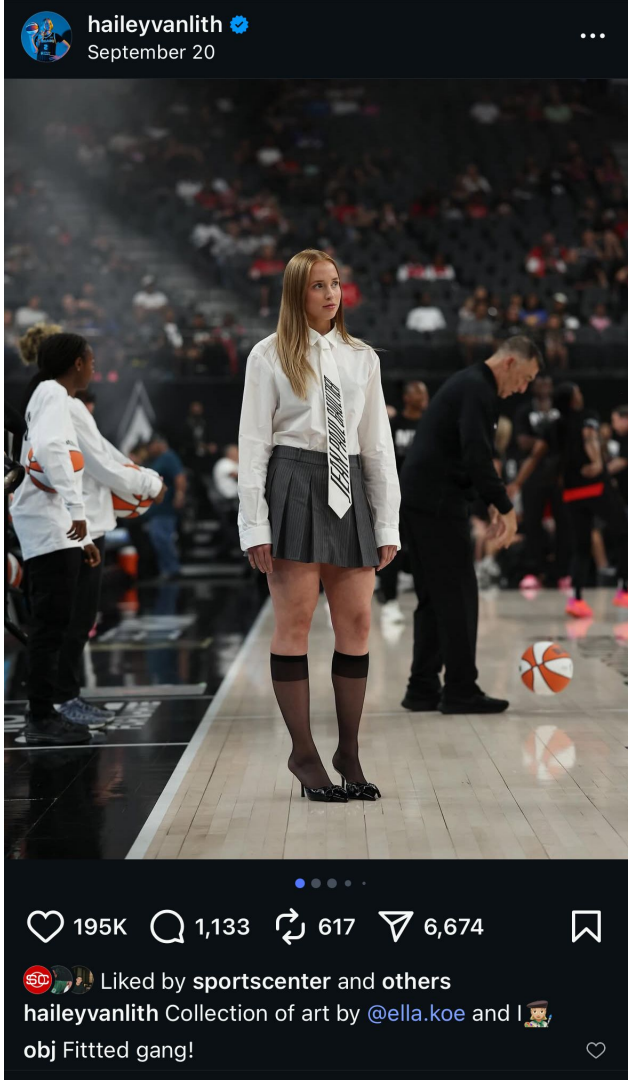
Category: Athletics x Personal

Posted April 8th, 2025 • 212k likes

Description: Hailey Van Lith partnered with Sports Illustrated and Sports Illustrated Swimsuit to post her confident personality to her page.

It was also notably highlighted on the Big12 conference Instagram page, marking one of the few Women's Athletes to be featured.

Category: Personal



Posted Sept. 20th, 2025 • 195k likes

Description: This post showed off Hailey Van Lith's impressive wardrobe collection. There were many slides each with unique outfits that adamantly expressed her style.

The post even attracted another LSU alumni Odell Beckham Jr. to comment complimenting her style.

Category: Lifestyle

Posted April 16th, 2025 • 182k likes

Description: Draft Day... one of the biggest moments in Hailey Van Lith's life is highlighted from her fan engagement.

HVL posted her draft day moments, including her walking the stage at the 11th pick to the Chicago Sky.

Category: All of them!

Target Audiences

Young Female Athletes
(Ages 12-20)

HVL represents a confident female athlete that is inspirational for expressing your true self. She is also very motivating, constantly promoting her strong work ethic to others.

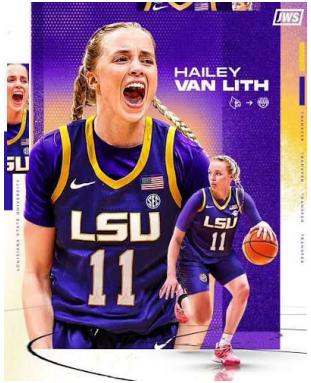
College Basketball fans
(Ages 18-34)

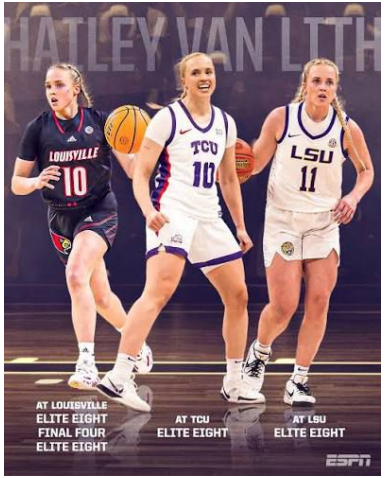
People who follow college basketball will notice her high-profile games. With HVL having an already prominent social following and great basketball skill set, she is a prominent figure for many sports fans to watch.

Lifestyle/fashion fans
(Ages 15-30)

Van Lith combines her personable behavior with her fashion. Her outfits stand out, which can ultimately bring a strictly fashion fanatic into being a WNBA fan.

Niche Audience: A female 18-20 year old interested in basketball and fashion





HVL's Unique Selling Point (USP)

Hailey Van Lith is an already high-visibility superstar whose intensity on the court matches her everyday lifestyle. She is a proven winner with a huge influence on a growing population of women's athletics.

Part Two

HVL ⇝ Brands

Existing Partnerships

Description: Hailey Van Lith's strongest partnerships exist mainly in the health, beauty, and fashion departments.

She recently has strong ties to the high-fashion brand "Coach" as well as the hair beauty brand "Batiste." Meanwhile, throughout her career, she has partnered with several brands in multiple categories…

- Food/Beverage: Gatorade, Pizza Hut, Lacroix
- Accessories: JLAB audio
- Miscellaneous: Sports Illustrated

*Note: HVL has multiple deals that are not represented anymore! Most notably American Eagle.

Recommended Partnership - Lululemon

Hailey Van Lith, a prominent figure for the sport of Women's basketball and the WNBA at large, should partner with the athletic wear company Lululemon!

HVL and Lululemon align by providing a fashionable product with an athletic wear brand. Lululemon is a strong female-athlete focused brand that works well with Van Lith's identity. It aligns her competitiveness without forgoing her fashionable lifestyle.

lululemon

*Note: 'Coach' brand does not restrict this partnership because Lululemon is not considered "high-fashion."

Benefits - HVL and Lululemon

HVL Benefits:

Van Lith gets to partner with a premium brand that produces high-quality products. Not only does she achieve an expanded audience, but also reaches mainstream recognition similar to her partnership with Pizza Hut.

Lululemon Benefits:

Lululemon can most notably capitalize on women's sports growth. HVL offers a gateway to access one of the most engaged female-athlete audiences. Not to mention HVL is a strong content creator with a large fanbase.

Part Three

HVL Activation Pitch

Physical Activation Initiative

INTRODUCING: “The HVL Method”

Presented by Lululemon

Location: Chicago, Illinois x Fort Worth, Texas

Outreach to communities to host two events starring Hailey Van Lith! HVL runs warm ups, shooting drills, and hosts a Q&A. Offer is open for 12-20 year old girls and an assisting family member if needed.

Fans will receive all of the photos they want and get a limited time offer for Lululemon x HVL apparel! It will also be covered by the local media surrounding the areas of the Chicago Sky and TCU campus, respectively.

How this wins: With a perfect overlap from our target audience, this matches Van Lith’s authentic personality. This is a high engagement activity with a strong outreach to HVL’s prominent locations in her scholastic and professional careers! It is also favorable for Lululemon’s brand image with community work.

Digital Activation Initiative

INTRODUCING: “The HVL Mindset”

Presented by Lululemon

Location: Online - TikTok videos & Instagram Reels

Hailey Van Lith will introduce “the Mindset Series” for weekly 20-30 second episodes with common themes of confidence, competitiveness, and battling adversity (especially with her current ankle recovery from surgery)

Lululemon apparel will naturally be integrated into videos as well as a possible hashtag challenge promotion!

- E.X: top video using #HVLmindset gets a free promotional Lululemon item!
- KPI’s: views, gained followers, and hashtag usage

How this wins: HVL already has strong presence on Instagram and TikTok. Capitalizing on a rookie WNBA athlete with her potential to be great can be a scalable victory for Lululemon. In return, Van Lith will have a comfortable and reliable clothing brand that suits her personal lifestyle and is natural in social media videos.

“Every dribble is a step closer to my dream”

- Hailey Van Lith

Let’s capitalize on that dream...